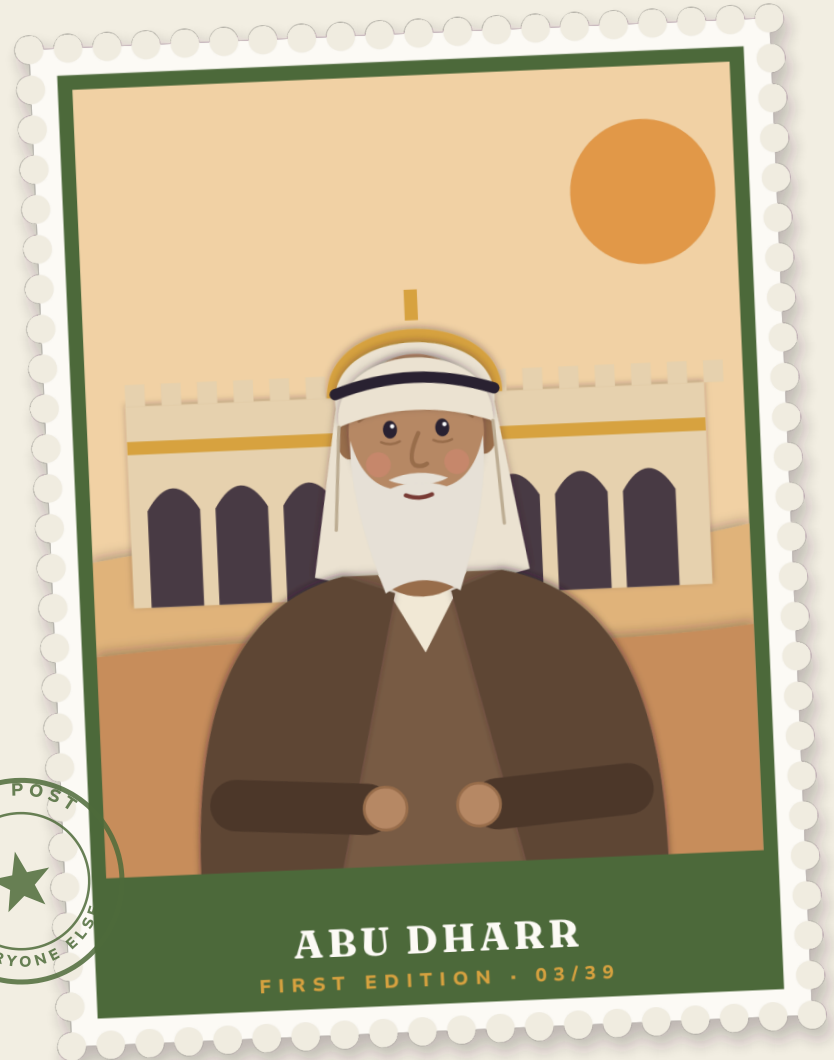


NOOR POST • EVERYONE ELSE

**Abu Dharr was sent
away for what he said
about the poor.**

FOR

[Child's name]





Noor Post
[Return address — not set]

EVERYONE ELSE • ABU
DHARR • INSIDE THE FLAP

Open together.

● is the grown-up. ○ is you.

- 1 The letter — read it out loud, ● and ○ taking turns
- 2 The hadith card
- 3 The print
- 4 The stickers
- 5 The postcard

Abu Dharr

- **Who he was.** From the Ghifar tribe, outside the cities and outside the clan politics of Makkah. He accepted Islam very early, among the first, and is described in the accounts as blunt to the point of difficulty.
- **What he was known for.** One argument, made repeatedly and in public: that wealth piled up while others go without is not a private matter. **He made it in Damascus, at the centre of the richest government in the world at that time.**
- **What was done about it.** He was not answered and he was not charged. He was moved — first out of Damascus, then out of Medina, then to al-Rabadha, a small place on a desert road.
- **How he lived.** Poorly, on purpose, all his life. This is not disputed by anybody, including people who found him exasperating.
- **What survives.** He is quoted in collections across every community, and the argument he made outlived every building it was made outside of.
- **Why he is in this envelope.** *Abu Dharr was sent away for what he said about the poor.*

He died at al-Rabadha, in exile, with almost no one present.

The Man They Sent Away



● is the grown-up · ○ is you · ●○ is together

- Twenty years after the Prophet died, the empire was rich. Really rich. Money was arriving in Damascus from three continents, and the men running it were building the kind of houses you build when nobody is going to stop you.

○ Was that allowed?

- That is the argument, and one old man would not drop it. His name was Abu Dharr, he had been one of the very first to accept Islam, and he had known all of them when none of them had anything.

○ What did he say?

- He was old by then, and he had come a long way to be there, and he sat down in the street outside the new buildings and said it out loud. That gold stacked in a room while people nearby have nothing is not a private matter. That it would be answered for.

○ To their faces?

- Outside their doors. Every day. To anyone passing. He had been saying versions of it his whole life and he was not going to stop because his friends had got comfortable.

○ **Did they argue back?**

- Some did, in public, with scholars brought in. But you cannot really win that argument in front of a crowd of people who own nothing, so they stopped arguing and moved him instead.

○ **Moved him where?**

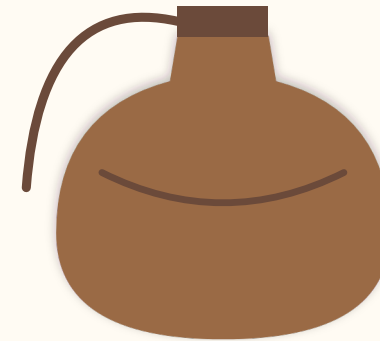
- Out of Damascus, then out of Medina, and finally to a place called al-Rabadha — a stop on a road in the desert with almost nobody in it. Not a prison. Just far away from anybody who might listen.

○ **Is that better or worse than prison? Say what you think.**

- He went. He did not go quietly, he did not stop saying it, and he did not have an audience any more. He lived there and he died there and there was almost nobody with him at the end.
- Nothing he said was ever answered. He was moved, which is not the same thing, and everybody involved knew the difference.

SAY THIS ONE TOGETHER

●○
**They never argued him
down. They just moved
him.**



Then the hadith card.

FIRST EDITION • 03/39

THE PROPHET SAID

**“Ask the scholars, speak
with the wise, and sit with
the poor.”**

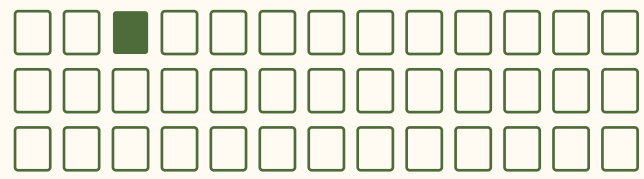
The Prophet Muhammad



NOT A SILSILA SEGMENT • THIS SET HAS ITS OWN CHAIN

The other chain

The box holds fourteen cards, one for each of the Fourteen.
This set is the people around them: thirty-nine cards, collected
in any order.



First edition · thirty-nine cards

IN OUR WORDS

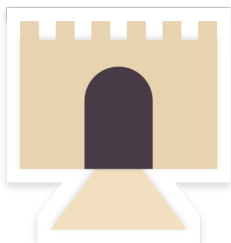
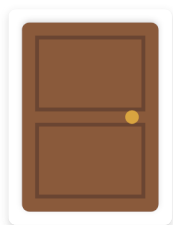
**Learn from people who know things,
talk with people who are wise, and
spend time with people who have little.**

Noor Post's own words, not the translation.

Tuhaf al-Uqul, short maxims of the Prophet, no. 40. Translated by
Badr Shahin, Ansariyan Publications, Qum.



Abu Dharr





**We opened this one
together.**

● _____

○ _____

Post it back to us, or keep it. Either is right.

STAMP

Noor Post

[Return address — not set]

